بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

Ibn Sina University

Faculty of Pharmacy

First-year- semester one

Introduction to Medical Education

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Grouping & Group Dynamics

Mohammed Taj Eldin Abdalla

B. Pharm., M. Pharm., Clinical Pharmacology

Email:Mohammedtaj654@gmail.com

❖ Intended Learning outcomes

- **By the end of this lecture, each student will be able to:**

1. Define the group and group dynamics.
2. Mention the types of the group.
3. Describe the stages of group development.
4. Describe the roles and types of group members.
5. Explain the importance of grouping and group dynamics.
6. Mention the factors that affect group dynamics.

Definitions

❖ Group

A **group** is some individuals who **come together to interact, collaborate, or achieve common goals or objectives.**

❖ Group Dynamics

Refers to the **patterns of interaction, behavior, and psychological** processes that occur within a group.

Types of Groups

- Groups can be categorized based on various criteria, including their purpose:

1. Formal Groups

Established by faculty or teachers for a specific purpose, **often with defined roles and responsibilities.**

Examples: Assignment groups, student seminar groups, and research groups.

2. Informal Groups

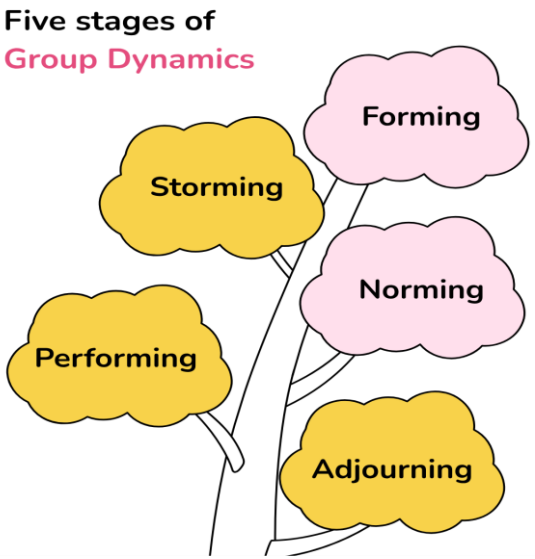
Formed naturally through social interactions and relationships, without official recognition or structure.

Examples: Friendships, and study groups.

Stages of Group Development

❖Groups typically go through several stages as they form and evolve:

1. **Forming:** Group members **come together**, establish ground rules, and understand their roles.
2. **Storming:** Conflicts may arise as **members express differing opinions** and assert their personalities.
3. **Norming:** The group **establishes norms, develops cohesion, and works collaboratively.**
4. **Performing:** Members **focus on achieving group goals** and leveraging individual strengths.
5. **Adjourning:** The **group disband**s after achieving its objectives or completing its tasks.



3. Roles of group members

- Members often take on specific roles that influence group dynamics:

1. Leader

Guides the group towards its goals, facilitates discussions, and makes key decisions.

Responsibilities: Setting the agenda, motivating members, and ensuring that everyone's voice is heard.

3. Recorder/Note-Taker (scribe)

Documents key points, decisions, and action items during meetings.

Responsibilities: Maintaining accurate records, summarizing discussions, and distributing minutes.

3. Timekeeper

Monitors time during meetings to ensure that the group stays on schedule.

Responsibilities: Reminding the group of time limits and managing the agenda to cover all topics.

4. Group members

They should contribute equally to achieve the goals of the group.

➢ Facilitator/ Tutor

Faculty staff member Helps manage group processes and ensure effective communication.

Responsibilities: Leading discussions, keeping the group on track, and encouraging participation.

Note: individual roles can disrupt group functioning if they focus on personal agendas (e.g., dominator, avoider).

Group members types

1. The argumentative type.
2. The positive type.
3. The know-all type.
4. The uncooperative type.
5. The shy type.
6. The uninterested type.
7. The intellectual type.
8. The persistent questioner.
9. Free riders.

Importance of grouping & group dynamics

Understanding group dynamics is vital for several reasons:

1. **Enhanced Collaboration:** Trust and respect among group members enhance collaboration, **leading to the sharing of ideas and resources**.
2. **Improved Decision-Making:** Teams often make better decisions by utilizing the collective knowledge and expertise of all members.
3. **Increased Motivation:** Positive group dynamics create a supportive environment where **members motivate each other**.
4. **Stronger Cohesion:** Cohesive teams, driven by a shared purpose, enhance communication, problem-solving abilities, and overall performance by **working towards common goals.**

Factors affecting group dynamics

Group dynamics are shaped by key elements, which are essential for effective teamwork and achieving group goals, and understanding these factors is crucial.

1. Interdependence

Group members' interdependence fosters teamwork and collaboration, as they understand their contributions impact the group's success.

2. Leadership Style

Effective leaders foster trust, open communication, and collaboration, enhancing group cohesion and productivity, **while authoritarian or ineffective leader**ship can hinder interaction and morale.

3. Group Size

Group size significantly influences dynamics, with **smaller groups exhibiting better communication and coordination**, while larger groups benefit from diverse perspectives but may **face coordination and decision-making challenges.**

4. Norms and Values

These norms influence how decisions are made, how conflicts are resolved, and how members support one another.

5. Communication Patterns

Open, honest communication fosters understanding and cooperation, while poor communication can lead to misunderstandings and conflicts.

6. Cohesion

High levels of cohesion can enhance motivation and collaboration, making it easier to accomplish tasks and achieve goals.

7. Trust

When team members feel safe sharing ideas without fear of judgment, creativity and problem-solving improve significantly.

8. Diversity of Members

Diverse group members affect dynamics by introducing varied perspectives and approaches to problem-solving.

9. Goal Clarity

A clear understanding of the group's goals **enhances motivation and coordination among members.**

10. Environmental Context

The **physical and social environment** in which a group operates can impact its dynamics. Factors such as available **resources, and external pressures** can influence how effectively a group functions.

ANY Qs

Thank You For Your Attention

HAVE A NICE DAY....

Next:... *Teaching and Learning Methods in Medical Education*

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Unity is strength... when there is teamwork and collaboration, wonderful things can be achieved.

MATTIE STEPANEK

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